



in an amazing range of products from CD players to dental drills to eye surgery equipment. They differ from other sources of light however as they emit light coherently, i.e. lightwaves that are not only all the same wavelength but also perfectly in step. Because of this quality, lasers can create an intense beam that can be focused to a tight spot, powerful enough to cause a hole in steel.

In fact, a laser beam is so straight and narrow that it can hit a mirror on the moon. While the first functioning laser did not come into operation until the 1960s, its theoretical foundations were created by none other than Albert Einstein years ago in 1917 in his paper on the “Quantum Theory of Radiation”. Today, there are all kinds of lasers such as gas lasers, chemical lasers, solid state lasers, fiber lasers, dye lasers and bio lasers for a whole host of applications. Weapon and medical technology aside, the most exciting innovation of lasers from a woman’s perspective is its ability to kill hair growth so that one never has to ever shave again. Also, the Bill & Melinda Gates Foundation funded *Intellectual Ventures* is developing a laser to kill mosquitoes to prevent malaria-related deaths.

## LCD

A LCD or liquid crystal display is a flat panel video display that uses the light modulating properties of liquid crystals. From computer monitors to televisions and instrument panels to gaming devices, LCD’s are common